

ON THE BRINK



It was to be retribution for the demolition of the Babri Masjid just months ago, and Dawood Ibrahim insisted on a sense of poetic justice. So on March 12, they had their bloody revenge as 12 bomb blasts, timed over a span of two hours, left over 300 dead and 1,500 injured in Bombay. The city, barely calm after the carnage of the post-Babri riots, would have been expected to explode into flames. But Bombay, a metaphor of modern India in its better days, was now in its fortitude, an example, if not a metaphor, for the country.

ONE TOUGH GUY K.P. S. Gill

For K.P.S. Gill, director-general of Punjab Police, an iron fist worked best in dealing with terrorism. And while his human rights record may not have been immaculate, his results were beyond reproach—from 3,000-plus deaths a year in 1991, he was counting in double digits. In Punjab, Gill broke the norm when he replaced the Army with the police on the frontline, turning the local-outsider fight in to one between Jat Sikh vs Jat Sikh, and winning the support of the people in the process.



FIRST CUT

India's first private air carrier, Jet Airways, began operations on May 5, with a fleet of four Boeing 737-300 aircraft. The first flights were from Bombay to Delhi and Madras

and ten other destinations. Naresh Goyal's maiden venture, though, had its share of adventure, when one of his planes landed at the Air Force base at Coimbatore, instead of the civilian airport.

<< DID YOU KNOW

Following his smashing debut with the soundtrack for Mani Ratnam's superhit, *Roja*, which sold over 25 lakh copies, composer A.R. Rahman's soundtrack for *Bombay* was already sold for Rs 80 lakh.